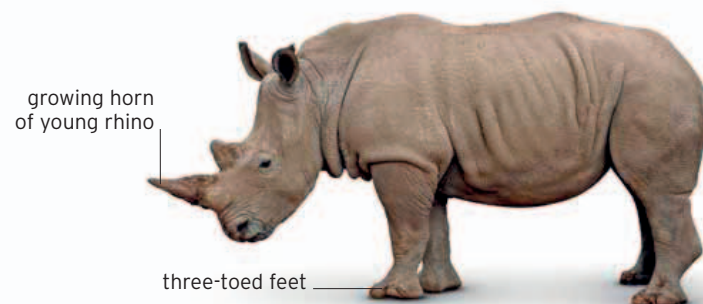




White rhinoceros

Ceratotherium simum

- ↔ 12–13 ft (3.7–4 m)
- 👤 Up to 5,000 lb (2,300 kg)
- ⊗ Near threatened
- 🌿 Grasses
- 🏠



E. and S. Africa

The white rhinoceros is one of the biggest mammals on earth, outweighed only by elephants and the semiaquatic hippopotamus. White rhinos are paler than their fellow African black rhinoceros, but still a dull lead gray. “White” is probably a misinterpretation of the Dutch/Boer term *wijd*, which means wide, referring to the animal’s broad mouth unlike the black rhino’s narrow, pointed lip. White rhinos graze with their heads held low, whereas black rhinos are browsers, grasping and twisting foliage from thorny

scrub. Their large size as well as a process of hind-gut fermentation allows them to extract sufficient nutrition from a high-volume yet low-quality grass diet.

Both African rhinos have two horns. The one in front can be exceptionally long, especially in females. Rhino horn, which is made of a hairlike material, is used in traditional medicine in some Asian countries. In an attempt to save the rhino, conservationists in some reserves remove the horn under anesthetic, thereby giving poachers no reason to kill the animal.

